

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

FDIC or similar deposit insurance protections, and prohibiting many common payroll card fees such as enrollment fees, wage-loading fees, point-of-sale transaction fees, and fees for the initial card and one replacement yearly.

The bill also requires employers to provide employees with disclosures regarding payment options, payroll card terms, fees, and methods for accessing wages without cost.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Section 1: States an employer will pay the wages with lawful money or with a check, draft or order.
Section 2: States an employer can credit employee wages to a payroll card account. This section also sets requirements for employers, stating they must notify the employee of the terms, conditions, and potential fees of the payroll cards.

Section 3: Provides for an effective date of July 1, 2026.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

N/A

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

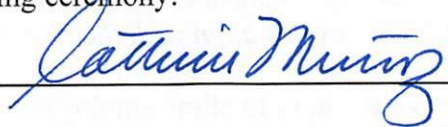
Support:

Amy Miller, Senior Director, Government Affairs – ADP amy.miller@adp.com

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

No suggestions for a bill signing ceremony.

Commissioner's Signature:   Date:

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken– to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DOL&WD

Date: 5/20/2026

Bill Number: SB79

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS): Payment of Wages; Payroll Card Account

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ **SIGN** ☐ **VETO** ☐ **LWOS**

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

The bill would provide clarity to both employers and employees regarding the rights and responsibilities associated with payroll card wage payments, a pay practice that is already common in Alaska and nationally and is expected to become increasingly prevalent as electronic wage payment methods continue to expand. The bill also establishes statutory protections for employees by requiring payroll card accounts to be federally insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation, the National Credit Union Administration, or another entity that insures bank deposits, where no explicit guarantee currently exists under Alaska law.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

This bill amends Alaska's wage payment laws to allow employers to pay employees through a payroll card account when the employee has not chosen direct deposit or voluntarily agrees to the payroll card option. The bill establishes consumer protections for employees using payroll cards, including requiring at least one free withdrawal each pay period, free balance inquiries,

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